

and Iliad, Aesop's Fables and Virgil's Aeneid. This is the most subtle cipher and can be interpreted in many different ways.

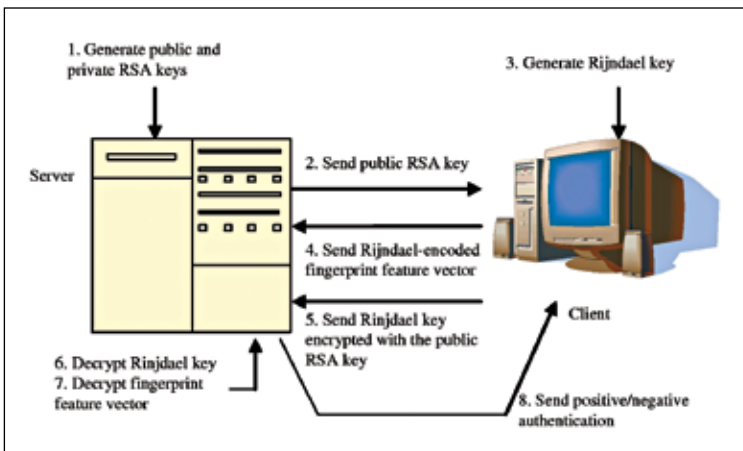
Indian elements

Cryptography was mentioned in the Kamasutra, written way back in the 4th century AD. Based on the manuscripts, it recommends that women should study 64 arts and one of them was the art of secret writing (mlecchita-vikalpa), so that they can hide the details of their liaisons. Early prototypes included a simple system where random pairing of the alphabets was followed by substitution with letters from a cipher.

The government also employed secret codes to communicate with spies distributed across the country. Apart from ciphers based on substitution, they also relied heavily on spoken or sign language communication.

Modern cryptography

While Vigenere's cipher was unbeatable for many, many years, all that was about to change as Charles Babbage added his unique element to cryptanalysis. An independent and wealthy Englishman, Babbage was credited for his work in computer science. He hacked systems in search of a repeated sequence of letters. Babbage's indigenous technique created waves and took cryptography to the next level, introducing mathematics in place of words.



Public key cryptography